Wine Tasting

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/75730016.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alcohol, Post-Canon, Protective Catra (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Drunk Adora (She-Ra), Implied Past Child Abuse

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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

It's after the war. Everything has calmed down. Adora is still recuperating. Etheria is in shambles. How can morale be raised? By a wine class, of course! Glimmer hosts a wine class to help the Best Friend Squad relax and unwind. Unfortunately, Adora is a light-weight.

(Based on the prompt "Wine Class", this week's weekly prompt in the SPOP Creative Flex server)

Notes

Sup, ya'll! Feeling super motivated to write right now! Hoping to do the weekly prompt regularly (two weeks in a row, yay!). I probably didn't need to tag "Past Child Abuse" but just in case, I figured over-tagging was better than under-tagging.

Anyway, without further ado!

See the end of the work for more notes

A myriad of scents greeted Catra as soon as she stepped foot into the (former) War Room. Sweet. Tart. Some scents were familiar. That was not in a good way though. It triggered something in her, something she couldn't recall. She felt her fur as it shifted and stood on its ends. Her tail began to lash behind her. There was something about the smells in this room. Something bad!

"Hey." She felt Adora lightly hipcheck her and then wrap an arm around her, pulling her close.

"You okay?" Adora prodded gently. She could hear the not-so-faint concern in Adora's voice. Funny. She should be asking Adora that.

She melted into Adora's side embrace, though she did steal a glance at Adora's side, just below her ribcage. It was hidden under her red jacket (a spare one that Glimmer and Bow had *somehow* dug up from somewhere) and white under-shirt, protected by a multitude of gauze, wraps, and bandages.

The wound.

Somehow even turning into She-Ra hadn't completely healed her. A part of Catra wondered why. She fought the urge to lift Adora's jacket and shirt to check it. Adora had *just* changed the bandages this morning. Surely she would have mentioned if it was bugging her. But then again, Adora wasn't always *great* at talking about things like that. Or at taking it easy when she was hurt. It was Adora's idea that the two of them race to the War Room. Usually, their races were close. Today it wasn't. Was Adora hurting?

She barely noticed Adora's gaze shifting away from her.

"Wow, this really wasn't what I was expecting when Glimmer called us here," Adora mused. Catra forced herself to look away from where the gash should be and followed Adora's gaze. The large, circular table held a plethora of bottles and glasses. Those bottles. They looked vaguely familiar. Catra's nose twitched as she sniffed the air, breathing in the scents.

Seriously, why did it all smell and look so familiar?

Poof!

"Adora! Catra!"

Catra hissed and clung to Adora, her claws digging in. Her tail puffed up. She could feel a mix of fabric and skin under her claws. She knew was breaking Adora's skin, she must have. Adora had stiffened, as if she was worried moving even slightly would cause her pain. A twinge of guilt hit her. She didn't want to cause Adora pain. Not anymore. Not ever again.

"Oh! Sorry, Catra," Glimmer smiled apologically.

Catra slowly retracted her claws. She could hear a relieved sigh from Adora and feel her relax. She loosened her grip on Adora and (slightly) moved away. She was aware that her tail was still puffed up, to her embarrassment. It continued to lash behind her, no matter how hard she tried to still it.

Adora seemed to notice. She discretely grabbed it as it whipped around near her, and inched closer to Catra, hiding it from view. She was grateful towards Adora at that moment. Even after all this time, she knew how to help and when.

"So, Glimmer," Adora began, immediately pulling the attention to her before either Sparkles or Arrow-Boy could remark on Catra's behavior just moments ago. "What are we doing here?"

"Wine class!" Sparkles replied with a huge grin, as if those two words answered everything.

Wine class? What was a wine– Oh! Wine… Catra's ears fell flat against her head again. That was Shadow Weaver's favorite drink. No wonder the smell was familiar. Stupid Shadow Weaver. Stupid wine. Stupid Bright Moon for having wine (and Shadow Weaver once upon a time) in the first place!

"Oh! Niceee… What's a wine class?" Adora asked, seemingly completely oblivious to Catra's discomfort. Did Adora not realize what wine was? How it was associated with Shadow Weaver?

"It's a class where you learn how to taste wine," Bow answered, smiling brightly. Was Arrow-Boy always this cheery?

Poof!

Glimmer vanished.

Poof!

She reappeared near the table, snatching a bottle from the table.

Two more *poofs* and Glimmer was suddenly standing behind Adora and Catra, a bottle of red wine in her hand. Did Sparkles have to poof everywhere?! Why couldn't she just *walk*?! Like a normal person? She wrapped her arms around both of them, pulling the three of them into an awkward hug.

"Alright, She-Ra, Horde Scum, time to teach you two about wine tasting!"

Seriously, why was Sparkles like this?

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"Adora!" Glimmer almost shrieked. Catra's ears flattened against her head. Did Sparkles always have to be this loud?

"What?" Adora asked, glancing at Glimmer, her brow furrowing in confusion. There was a slight panic in her eyes, something that Sparkles probably missed completely, but Catra noticed it.

"You aren't supposed to swallow it," Bow cut in, his tone *much* softer and kinder than Glimmer's.

Adora stared at Bow. The panic in her eyes was gone at least (a good thing too). The confusion on her face was more prevalent

though.

"Why not?" Adora asked, frowning as if she had broken some unknown but apparently obvious rule. *THIS* was why Catra had issues with the Princess Alliance and Bright Moon; too many arbitrary rules. It was wine. Wine was a drink. Why not swallow it? (Although Catra had no intention of drinking it, the smell alone was making her stomach queasy).

"So, for a wine class, like this one, we taste it," Bow clarified kindly. Seriously, how was Arrow-Boy this kind but Sparkles wasn't? Sparkles always seemed to forget (conveniently, Catra might add) that her and Adora weren't *from* Bright Moon. They were from the Horde. And mundane (and stupid) things such as *wine tasting* wasn't a thing in the Horde.

"Okay?" Adora was staring at Bow, blinking in confusion.

"So you just take a sip, swish around in your mouth; letting it touch every taste bud, and then spit it out," Bow explained.

"Like this," Sparkles cut in, taking an already slightly filled glass from the table. She took a (somehow) dignified sip. Catra's ears perked up and twitched as she could hear the muffled sound of it swirling in Sparkles' mouth. Then, Glimmer took another cup (one that wasn't glass and where the contents weren't visible unless one was looking over it) and spit it out.

"See, you don't actually drink it, Adora. You just taste it." At least now Sparkles didn't sound annoyed or frustrated. She actually sounded *amused* by the whole situation.

"Okay. Taste it," Adora repeated, more to herself than to the others Catra imagined.

Adora took an already opened bottle and poured a little into a glass. She brought it up to lips and took a sip– A completely inhaled it, as if she had already forgotten what Bow and Glimmer had *just* said.

“Adora!” Both Glimmer and Bow chided in exasperation.

Catra sighed but didn’t say anything. Adora… A faint smile tugged at her as she watched her idiot’s face turn red as she realized her mistake. Adora smiled sheepishly at the other two, apologizing. It only took a few seconds for the disappointment of the moment to melt away and soon all three of them were smiling and laughing.

A swell of… *something* hit Catra then. She felt warm, like in her heart. What was that? She had felt something similar sometimes when she was around Scorpia and Entrapta back in the day. She used to feel all the time when her and Adora were kids, before Adora left her and joined the Rebellion. Was she happy? Was that what this feeling was? Joy?

“Catra!”

Adora’s voice, bright and cheery, shone like a light through Catra’s thoughts. An ear flickered in Adora’s direction. “Hmm?”

“Aren’t you going to try some?” Adora was handing her a glass she realized. The red liquid smelled sweet. Too sweet. And way too familiar for her liking. She wanted to reach out and take the glass, if only because it was Adora offering it. She couldn’t though. The memories associated with the scent. The way Shadow Weaver seemed to *change*... It was weird. Shadow Weaver seemed more *pleasant* whenever she held that sweet smelling glass. She actually seemed like she cared. Despite that, Catra didn’t want to try it. She wished Adora wasn’t trying it but she wouldn’t stop her. Enough people had tried to tell Adora what to do. Maybe it was time Adora got to choose for herself.

“No, I’m… I’m good,” Catra replied, giving Adora a small smile in an attempt to reassure her. She hoped it would work. She really didn’t feel like explaining her distaste for wine (at least not right now).

Adora frowned but took the glass back.

"Party pooper," Glimmer chastised, though the grin on her face told Catra that Sparkles wasn't being serious right now.

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"Maybe I should've let Sparkles take us to our room," Catra grumbled.

Adora was slung over her, her face bright red and seemingly barely conscious. She let out a chortled laugh. Alright, so still conscious, that was good… Right? The two of them stumbled through the halls of Bright Moon, Catra doing *most* of the walking. She held one of Adora's arms in an iron grip, afraid to let go, lest Adora should slide off of her and fall.

All that power as She-Ra and yet alcohol could easily do her in. If only she had known during the war. Wait. Scratch that. Maybe it was good she didn't know. The thought of using alcohol to render Adora useless and prime for capture felt wrong. Deeply so.

"Almost there," Catra murmured in relief. She recognized this hallway. Their bedroom door was only a couple of doors down.

"I'm so glad you're here…" Adora's voice was muffled. At some point her ponytail had come undone and at some point during their trek from the (former) War Room to the bedroom, her hair had toppled over and spilt over her face. When did that happen?!

"I'm glad too," Catra mumbled in reply, her voice straining as Adora was just (a tad) too heavy for her to carry this long. It was muscle, all muscle; of that, Catra had no doubt.

"I hated when you were gone," Adora continued, her voice thick as if she was on the verge of tears. What was going on?

"Sorry," Catra muttered. They were so close to their room now.

"I shouldn't have left." Adora sniffed. Catra felt something wet drop onto her shirt. Was Adora crying? She felt a twinge of guilt. It wasn't Adora's fault; not entirely, at least. Adora *had* tried to

bring her to Bright Moon but– Wait! Why were they talking about this?! Catra sighed. She needed to get Adora to bed and sleep off this drunken state. She did not have the mental (or emotional) strength for this right now.

"We're almost to our room, alright? We'll take a nap and then everything will be better." Catra hoped that Adora was paying attention, that she heard her and understood, at least a little.

Finally, she made it to their door. She wrestled an arm out from under Adora and turned the doorknob to open it. They stumbled in, Catra carrying an ever-weeping Adora to the bed.

"I'm sorry, Catra, I'm so, so sorry," she continued to wail.

Every sorry caused another twinge of guilt to hit Catra. It wasn't Adora's fault. She had given her the chance to leave. For whatever reason (Catra couldn't even remember now), she just hadn't. If she had that day to do over again, would she have left with Adora?

Catra turned around as she approached the bed. She reluctantly released her tight grip on Adora's arm and let the blonde slide off of her and onto the mattress. She was grateful that Sparkles had gotten that dingy old cot replaced with an actual bed as soon as she had asked.

Catra bent down and began to undo the laces on Adora's boots then and gently pulled them off of her feet. She stood back up, her gaze washing over Adora's tired frame. A smile touched her lips. She kicked the boots a little further away from the bed and then climbed up beside Adora. The lingering smell of the wine still stung her nose. One day, she would tell Adora the reason for her distaste for wine, one day.

Adora turned onto her side and reached up, her fingers lightly brushed Catra's hair. A low rumble erupted in Catra's throat. Adora's eyes still sparkled from the tears but a new light shone in

them then. A smile, small at first, and then gradually growing, took over her face.

“I always liked your purrs,” Adora said quietly.

Catra purred louder then. Adora was the only one she would intentionally purr for.

“Lay with me?" Adora asked quietly.

“Of course, dummy,” Catra replied, her voice just as soft.

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When Glimmer and Bow came to check on them later, they were wrapped in each other’s embrace. Catra’s rumbling purrs had filled the room. Her tail was wrapped around Adora’s leg. Adora had embraced her tightly. Without a word, the two of them had turned off the light and shut the door.

“Told you so,” Glimmer whispered as they stood outside Adora and Catra’s room. A huge grin on her face.

End Notes

Thank ya'll so much for reading! If you feel so inclined, please leave kudos and/or a comment! They let us authors know that someone out there in the vast internet read and enjoyed their story! Doesn't matter how old the story is. I have some past weekly prompts I'm hoping to finish (or start writing) soon! So if you've enjoyed these little one-shots, be on the look out!

Also, if you've been reading my other works, I am slowly making progress on the next (and last) chapter of "A Mis-Sent Text and a Discovery", my goal is to have that posted before 2026. Anyway, thank you again for reading! Happy Holidays!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!